

Experiment - 2 : Setting Up a Zoho Creator Account and Exploring the Platform Architecture and Interface

Aim:

To create and access a Zoho Creator account and explore the platform architecture, features, and user interface while creating and examining an **Insurance Claim** low-code application.

Theory:

Zoho Creator is a cloud-based low-code application development platform that enables users to build custom business applications with minimal coding. It provides a visual development environment where applications can be designed using drag-and-drop components, forms, workflows, reports, and dashboards.

The platform architecture consists of the following components:

- **Applications:** Containers that hold forms, reports, workflows, pages, and settings.
- **Forms:** Used to collect and store data such as insurance claimant and policy details.
- **Reports:** Display and manage stored claim data in formats such as lists and tables.
- **Pages:** Custom interfaces that combine multiple components into a single view.
- **Workflows:** Automate tasks using event-based actions and business logic, such as confirmation emails.
- **Deluge Script:** Zoho Creator's scripting language used to implement advanced functionality and automation.
- **Users and Permissions:** Control access to applications and define user roles.

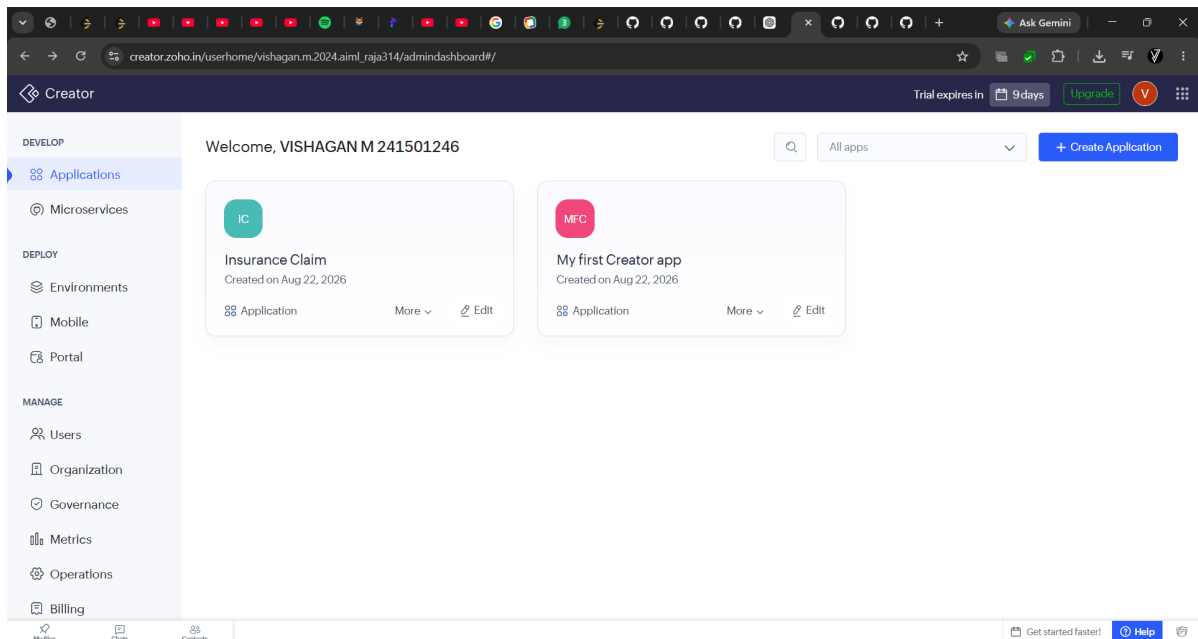
The Zoho Creator interface includes the Home Dashboard, Application Builder, Form Designer, Report Builder, Workflow Builder, navigation options, and Settings menu. These components work together to design, test, and manage the Insurance Claim application.

Procedure:

1. Open a web browser and navigate to the Zoho Creator website.

Sign in to the Zoho Creator account and open the Zoho Creator home dashboard.

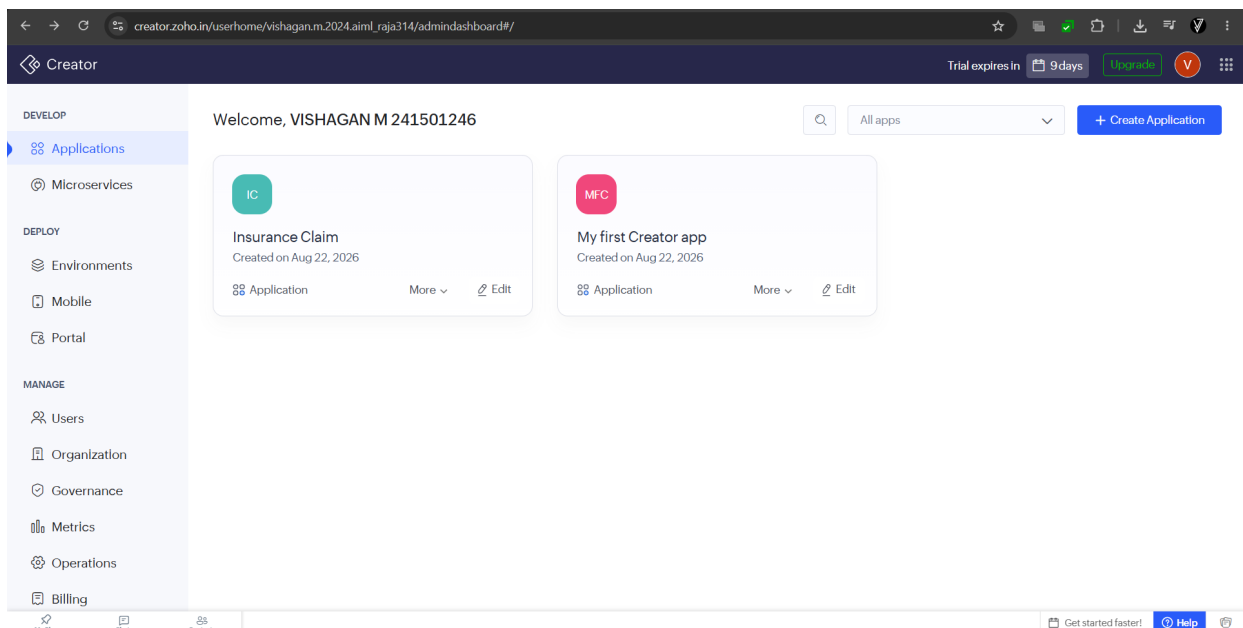
Fig. 2.1: Zoho Creator Home / Applications Dashboard



2. Access the Zoho Creator account and application dashboard.

The dashboard provides access to the applications available to the user. The created **Insurance Claim** application is visible here.

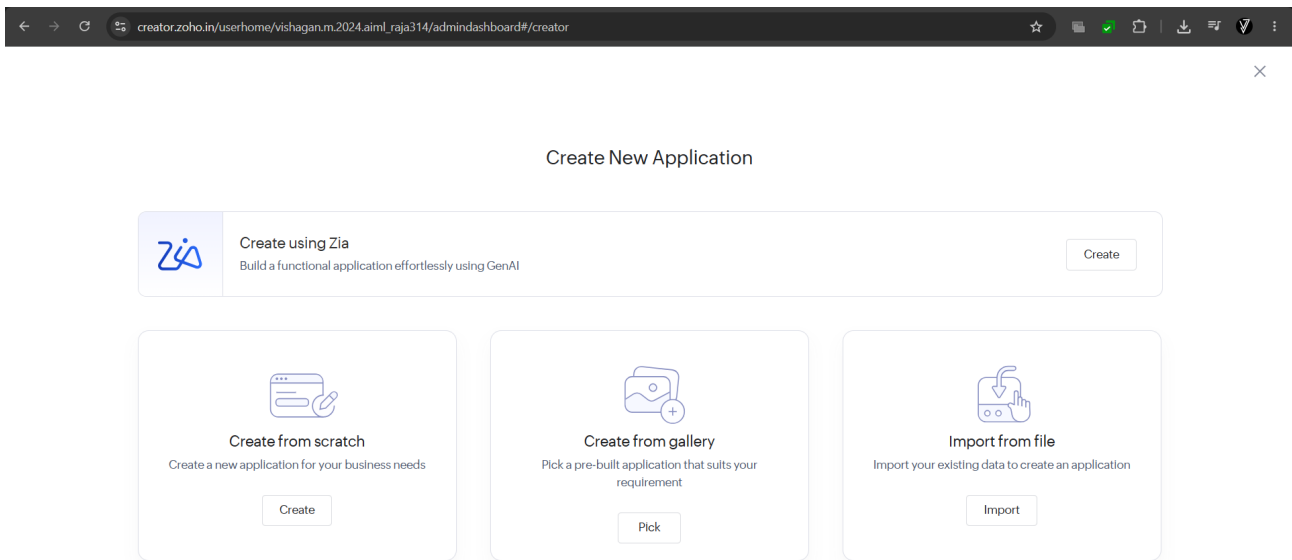
Fig. 2.2: Zoho Creator Account and Application Dashboard



3. Examine the application area.

The dashboard provides options for opening an existing application or creating a new one.

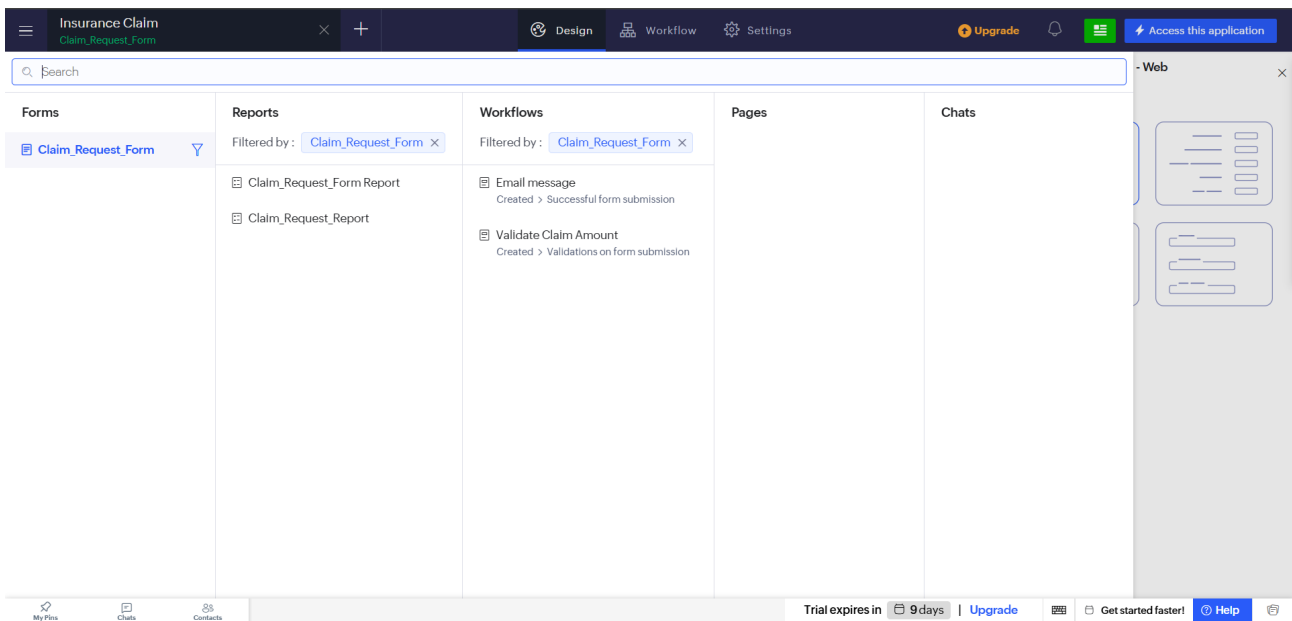
Fig. 2.3: Create Application Interface



4. Create or explore a new application using the available options.

Zoho Creator allows an application to be created using Zia, from scratch, from a gallery, or by importing a file.

Fig. 2.4: Insurance Claim Application Builder / Navigation Interface



5. Explore the Application Builder interface.

The Application Builder provides access to forms, reports, workflows, and other application components.

Fig. 2.5: Insurance Claim Form Designer

The screenshot displays the 'Insurance Claim Form Designer' interface. On the left, a 'Basic Fields' panel offers various input field types like Name, Email, Address, Phone, Single Line, Multi Line, Number, Date, Time, and Drop Down. The central workspace shows a form layout with fields for Claimant Name, Claimant Type, Policy Number, Email Address, Contact Number (currently selected), Residential Address, Claim Type, Date Of Incident, Claim Amount Requested, and Supporting Documents Available. On the right, the 'Field Properties' panel provides configuration options for the selected 'Contact Number' field, including its name, link name, validation rules (Mandatory is checked), data privacy settings (Contains personal data is checked), data security options (Encrypt data and Contains health info are unchecked), and visibility settings. The bottom of the interface includes a status bar with a trial expiration notice and navigation links.

6. Examine the Form Designer and the fields used in the Insurance Claim application.
The form contains fields for claimant name, claimant type, policy number, email address, contact number, residential address, claim type, date of incident, claim amount, and supporting documents.

Fig. 2.6: Insurance Claim Sample Data Entry Form

Insurance Claim

Claimant Name *
First Name: Vishagan, Last Name: M

Claimant Type *
☐ Policyholder
☐ Nominee
☐ Third Party

Policy Number *
123

Email Address
vishaganjanuary@gmail.com

Contact Number *
+91 09360486974

Residential Address
7/648, Govindasamy Nagar, Harur
Address Line 1: 7/648, Govindasamy Nagar, Harur
Address Line 2: Tamil Nadu
City / District: 636903, State / Province: India

7. Enter sample data into the created form.

Open the Insurance Claim form in live/user mode and enter sample claimant and policy information into the fields.

Fig. 2.7: Claim Request Report Displaying Submitted Record

Insurance Claim

Claimant Name: Vishagan M, Claimant Type: Policyholder, Policy Number: 123, Email Address: vishaganjanuary@gmail.com, Contact Number: +919360486974, Residential Address: 7/648, Govindasamy Nagar, Harur, Tamil Nadu, 636903, Claim Type: Health Insurance

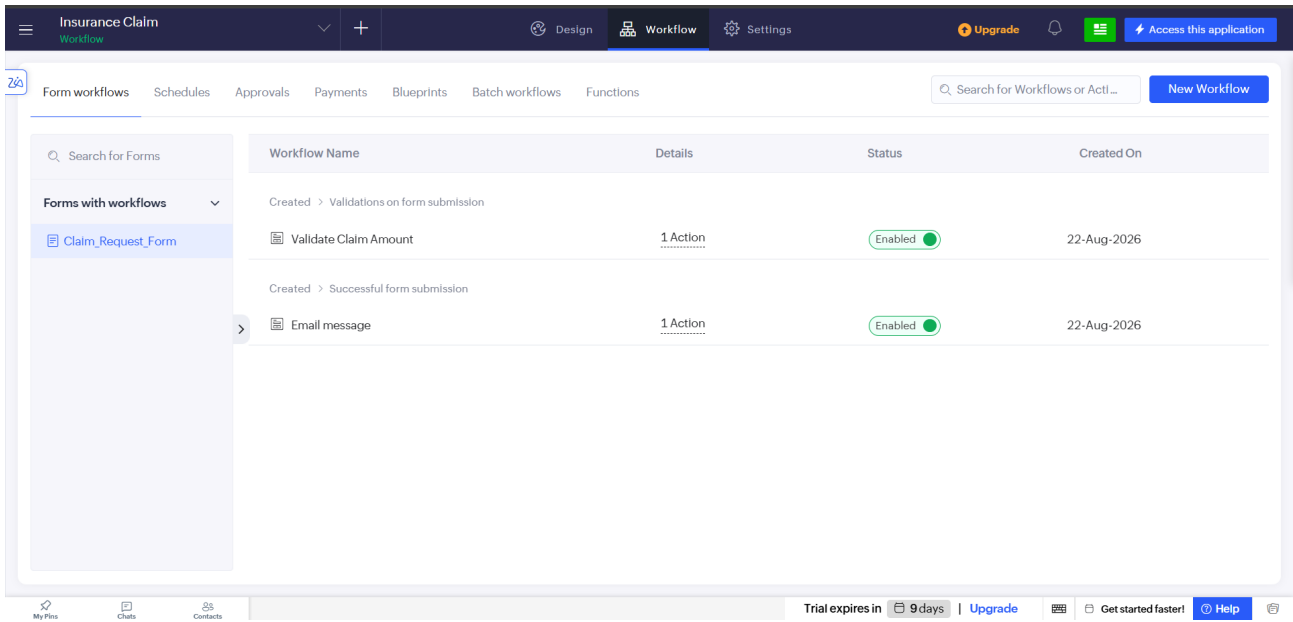
Claimant Name	Claimant Type	Policy Number	Email Address	Contact Number	Residential Address	Claim Type
Vishagan M	Policyholder	123	vishaganjanuary@gmail.com	+919360486974	7/648, Govindasamy Nagar, Harur, Tamil Nadu, 636903	Health Insurance

8. Explore the Report Builder to view the generated records.

Submit the sample form and open the Claim_Request_Report. The report displays the data collected through the form.

Form → Data → Report

Fig. 2.8: Workflow Builder with Insurance Claim Workflows



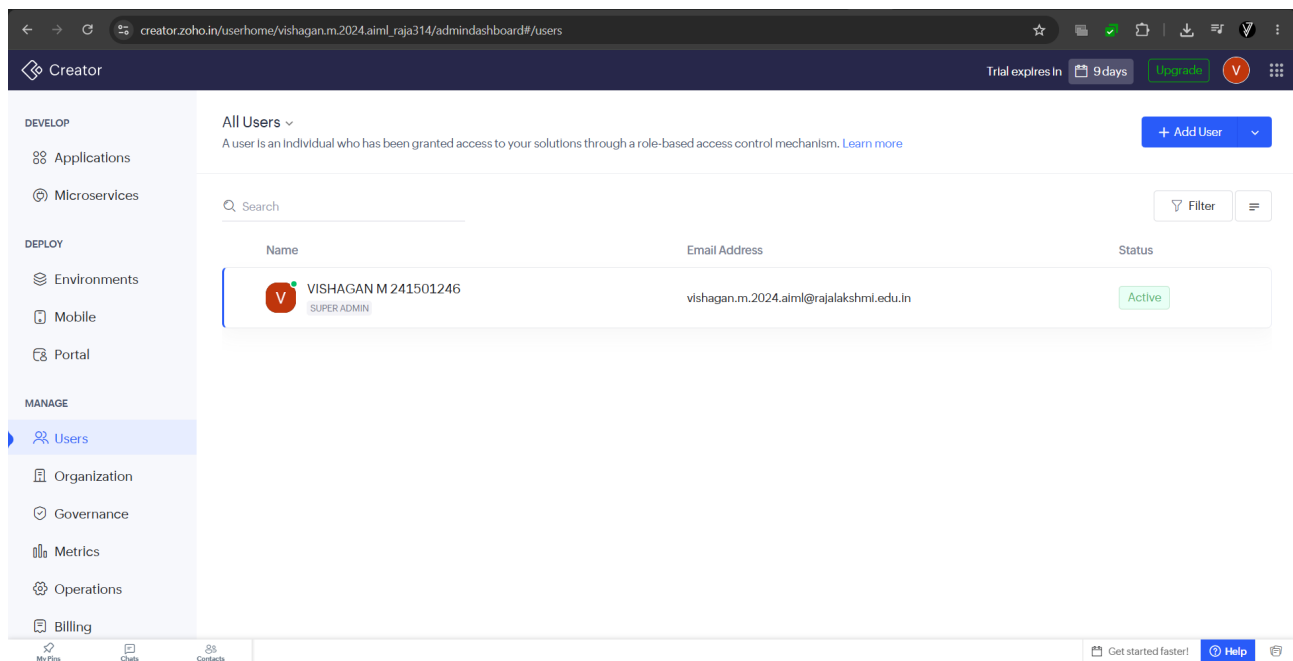
9. Navigate through the Workflow section to understand automation features.

The Insurance Claim application contains workflows such as claim validation and a successful form submission email. Workflows execute actions at specific events to automate routine tasks.

10. Observe the relationship between the form and workflow.

After a successful claim submission, the configured workflow can trigger an automated email confirmation to the claimant.

Fig. 2.9: Zoho Creator Users and Access Management



11. Explore user management and application access.

Zoho Creator provides user management and role-based access control so administrators can control who can access applications and their components.

12. Observe the application-level administration options.

The management area provides administrative controls for users and organization settings.

13. Explore the Deluge Script environment.

Deluge is integrated into Zoho Creator for implementing functions and advanced application logic. It can be used for validations, calculations, notifications, and workflow actions in the Insurance Claim application.

14. Observe the overall platform architecture and note the functions of each component.

The basic architecture explored during the experiment can be represented as:

Application → contains the complete Insurance Claim solution

→ **Forms** - Collect and store claim information

→ **Reports** - Display and analyze stored claim data

→ **Pages** - Provide customized user interfaces

→ **Workflows** - Automate tasks and business processes

→ **Deluge Script** - Implement advanced logic and functionality

→ **Users & Permissions** - Control access to the application

Result:

A Zoho Creator account was successfully accessed, and the platform architecture and user interface were explored using the **Insurance Claim** application. The experiment demonstrated the use of forms, reports, workflows, user management, and other low-code components for rapid application development.